

Conversation #01

CONVERSATION

A FAMILY MEETING

Teacher's note: Get 6 pieces of paper, number them 1 to 6 and have each student draw one to see which character they will be.

A family is having a meeting called by **Sally**, the daughter who is 20. She is complaining that **Mike**, the son, who is 18, is treated like an adult whereas she is treated like a child. Moreover, **Mike** can drive the family car and she can't. She does all the house chores while **Mike** goes out with friends or simply does nothing but lie on the sofa and watch TV. Everyone thinks that he or she is correct. Who will win the argument?

1. **Sally:** you're an extremely gorgeous chick who is envied by all the girls in the neighborhood — not only for that, but also mostly because of Joshua, an extremely handsome young doctor who is crazy about you. You complain that you can only date on Saturday nights and only in the living room couch in front of your parents and grandparents. You feel miserable for living like a nun and claim that washing dishes ruins your fingernails and skin. You reckon that folks at college laugh behind your back because you're the only one not allowed to travel or even go camping with your boyfriend — which could lead to Joshua being taken away by one of the thousands of girls who chase after him at the first opportunity. You fear ending up an old maid.
2. **Mike:** you are extremely family-dependent and pampered by **Dad**. You get anything you dream of and you travel with your girlfriend at your father's expense. When you bring her to sleep over, you make your **Dad** proud of his "macho" son. Whenever your sister complains about you using the family car you respond ironically: *"I've never wrecked Daddy's car!"* and *"Girls are to be driven, not drive."*
3. **Dad:** You have a motto: *"Princess, I know what bad intentions young men have. They're big bad wolves — I was one once."* You insist **Sally** must be looked after like Little Red Riding Hood. (This drives **Sally** nuts.)
4. **Mom:** you try to cool things down but to no avail. You agree with daddy (as usual) and you think **Mike** is more responsible. You feel sorry for **Sally** but you try to make her see that she is better off than you once were. You recall that the curfew you had as a girl was 9:00 p.m. on school nights, 11:00 p.m. on weekends. You always say: *"In my days..."*
5. **Grandpa:** you are on **Sally's** side, but you are also on **Mike's** side.
6. **Grandma:** you adore **Mike** and you agree with your daughter (**Mom**). You say that the curfew you had as a girl was 7:00 p.m. on school nights, 10:00 p.m. on weekends, and that you couldn't date until you were 18. You also always say: *"In my days..."*

COMPOSITION

Write about your family. Who is considered the favorite? Who doesn't get along well together? Why?

Full Name: _____

Theme: _____

Title: _____

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